





Big Events

Concert

Religious ceremony

**Which of these types
of “big events” have
you been to?**

Festival

Sports match

National celebration



Big Events



Concert

Religious ceremony

**Why do people enjoy
attending these types
of events?**

Festival

Sports match

National celebration

Think

It's time to read the news!



We are going to read about a big event in a minute.
First, let's talk about the headline "**Pope-mania grips Paris**".

What do you think we are going to read about?

What do you know about this topic?



Before we read: Vocabulary focus



Match the words with their meaning

Gathered

A strong feeling of excitement and interest

Open-air

The feeling or mood of a place or situation

Immediate gratification

Made people interested enough to attend or participate

Sermon

Came together in the same place, usually as a group

Attracted

The feeling of being respected and valued

Dignity

Happening outside, not inside a building

Enthusiasm

A speech by a religious leader

Atmosphere

Getting what you want straight away, not waiting

Before we read: Vocabulary focus



Match the words with their meaning

Gathered	Came together in the same place, usually as a group
Open-air	Happening outside, not inside a building
Immediate gratification	Getting what you want straight away, not waiting
Sermon	A speech by a religious leader
Attracted	Made people interested enough to attend or participate
Dignity	The feeling of being respected and valued
Enthusiasm	A strong feeling of excitement and interest
Atmosphere	The feeling or mood of a place or situation

It's time to read the news!



While we read, you will notice the words from the vocabulary focus. Make a note of any other **words** or **expressions** that you don't understand.



Pope-mania grips Paris



26th September 2026

Around 800,000 people **gathered** in Paris on Saturday to see Pope Leo XIV celebrate a huge **open-air** Mass at the Place de la Concorde. The crowd, many waving French and Vatican flags, stretched along the Champs-Élysées.

The Mass was the main event of the Pope's four-day visit to France. During his **sermon**, he warned people about material goods and **immediate gratification**, saying that modern life can leave people feeling empty. Speaking directly to young people, he told them: "You are the Church today."

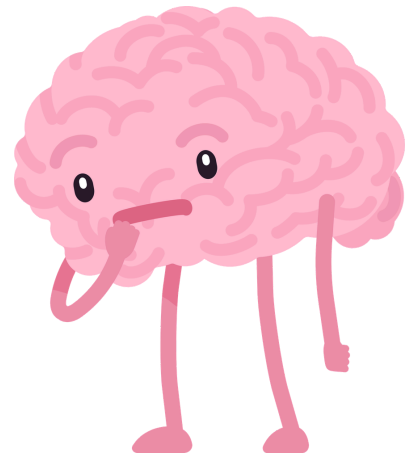


The event **attracted** people from across France and other countries. Some had travelled long distances to be there. One young man even arrived from London at 3am because it was his birthday and he did not want to miss the Mass.

The Pope's visit also attracted several important French politicians and former presidents. He had earlier met migrants and spoke about the importance of living together in **dignity** and peace.

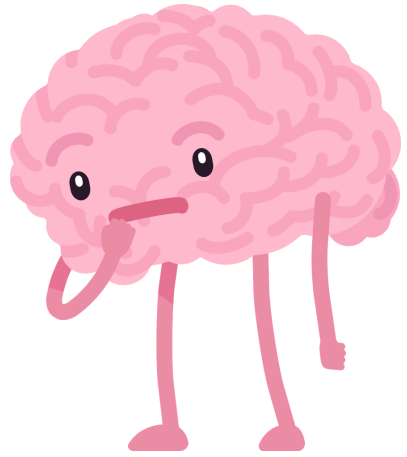
The huge crowds and **enthusiasm** have led some observers to compare the **atmosphere** with Pope John Paul II's visits to France decades ago.

Article adapted from The Daily Telegraph



Check your understanding of the article

1. How many people gathered to see the Pope in Paris?
2. The Pope said “you are the church”, to who?
3. The article mentions a man from London, what time did he arrive in Paris?
4. The Pope spoke to migrants about living in dignity and _____.



Check your understanding of the article

1. How many people gathered to see the Pope in Paris?

Over 800,000

2. The Pope said “you are the church”, to who?

He said it to the young people

3. The article mentions a man from London, what time did he arrive in Paris?

He arrived at 3am

4. The Pope spoke to migrants about living in dignity and _____.

Peace



Pope-mania grips Paris



We have read that **800,000 people** lined the streets for the Pope's visit to Paris.

Do you think all 800,000 people are strict **Catholics**? If not, **why** did they want to go to this event?



I was there!!!

Situation:

You are at a huge event.

You have a **perfect view** of what is happening.
There are **professional cameras** filming everything
from much better angles.

So why do you still take out your phone and record it?



I was there!!!

Discuss:

Why do people film concerts, football matches and other events on their phones?

Do people film things because they want to remember them, or because they want to show other people?

Does filming an experience sometimes stop us from actually experiencing it?

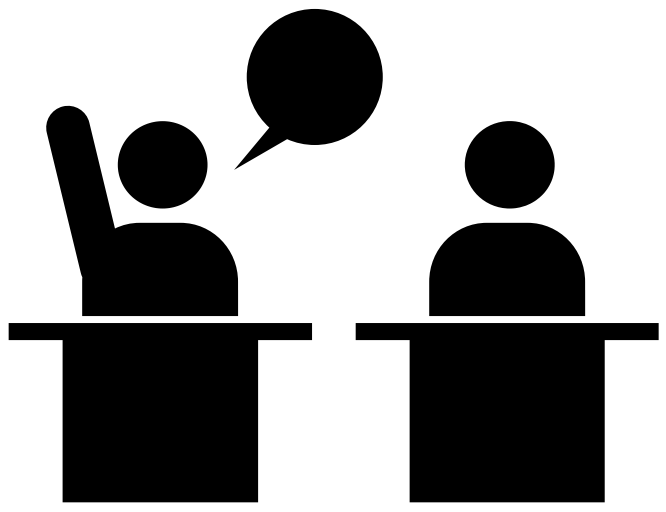
Would you rather experience a huge event in person or watch professionally filmed coverage at home? Why?



Hot Take

Do you agree?

**People are more
interested in proving they
were there than actually
enjoying the experience.**



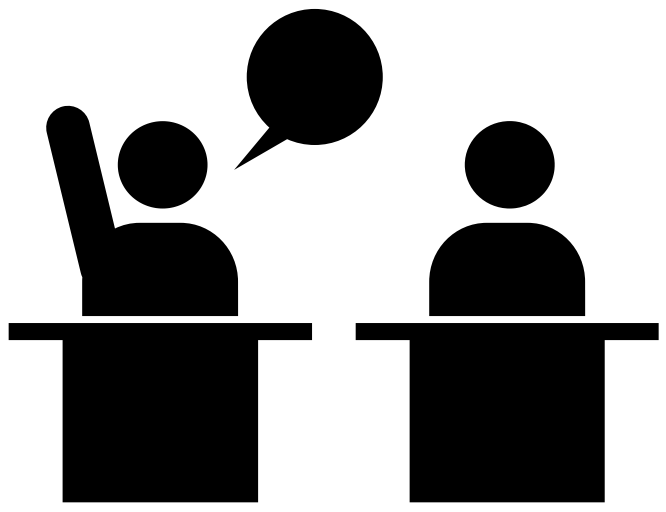
Final Task

To finish this lesson, we are going to have some debates.
Choose a side of the argument and defend it. There are
some useful opinion phrases to help you.

Tip: Whilst debating, use
the ideas which we have
seen and discussed in
this class

Useful phrases

- I get what you mean, but...
- I see it differently to you...
- As far as I'm concerned...
- I strongly believe...



Final Task

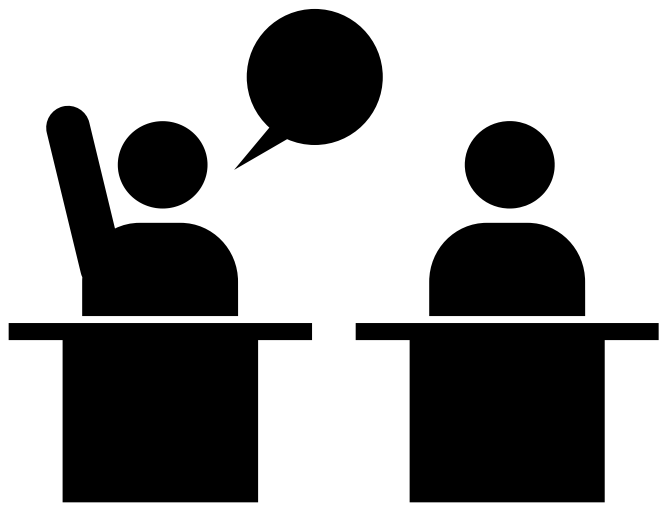
Choose your side, and defend it in the debate

Topic 1 of 2

Mobile phones should
be banned from sports
events and concerts

Useful phrases

- I get what you mean, but...
- I see it differently to you...
- As far as I'm concerned...
- I strongly believe...



Final Task

Choose your side, and defend it in the debate

Topic 2 of 2

People only go to big events
because they want to feel
part of something

Useful phrases

- I get what you mean, but...
- I see it differently to you...
- As far as I'm concerned...
- I strongly believe...



End of lesson review

In this lesson I have

- ✓ Discussed a variety of big events
- ✓ Read and understood an article about the Pope
- ✓ Looked into reasons for attending events and using phones there
- ✓ Used a variety of expressions in a debate